

Money in Russia

Money has become a powerful tool which influences people's lives. In contemporary world money matters a lot as people deal with money affairs in all fields of their activity. They get a loan from a bank to buy a car. They pay mortgage with a high interest rate to buy an apartment. They make purchases in the department stores to buy food and clothes. Thus, money satisfies people's needs and requirements.

The level of consumption has risen considerably and seems to never stop growing. The more goods people consume, the more money they are willing to spend. However, the standard of living in Russia has decreased dramatically so most people tighten their belts and make ends meet. They manage to pay electricity, heating, gas and telephone bills but they cannot afford anything more. The low-income group of population includes the disabled, unemployed and retired. The government pays people with a handicap disability allowances which help them to keep their head above water. Employees who have been made redundant or sacked can get unemployed benefits.

Students can also be referred to as the weakest stratum of our society. They cannot get student loans to pay fees or take a year off before they get a higher education. Nevertheless, Russian students get a scholarship or even a grant for achievements. Women in Russia don't get enough social protection when they expect a child and go away on a maternity leave. The state provides women with child benefits only after they give birth to the second child.

People in Russia have the right to work at the age of 14. Income depends on the degree, qualification, experience, stamina, luck, and many other factors. Most people work for firms, get salaries and save up for trips and expensive purchases. After vacations they are usually hard-up and cut back on unnecessary expenses.

People who are self-employed are called entrepreneurs. They are usually tight-fisted and aren't rolling in money in vain. Well-off businesspeople are take-riskers and think outside the box. They invest money in a profitable business or shares of successful companies or at least open saving accounts. They set up their own companies and become tycoons or moguls.

Customers in Russia withdraw money from the ATMs and pay in cash or by credit card. They look for bargains and don't mind getting reductions. If the thing is good value for money, Russian people tend to pay through the nose. Most foreigners consider Russians spendthrifts who blow money. When they run out of money, they feel like borrowing from acquaintances and then they pay it back. Nowadays Russian people dream of making a killing and going from rags to riches no matter how much they will have to pay for their luxurious life.